

CITA01 – Foundations of City Studies Summer 2026

June 22nd, 2026

Course Instructor: Olivia Bernard

Creative Class

Objectives

Discussion

Gentrification
and
Displacement

Assignment
2

Regent Park

Course Update

This week - Creativity, Innovation and Economic Development

- July 6 - Reflections on Urban Planning
- July 13 - Reflections on Urban Design
- July 20 - Sustainability, Resilience, and the Future of Cities
- July 27 - Artificial Intelligence and Urban Change
- August 6 - Exam Review and Course Evaluation

Tutorial Schedule



JULY 6



JULY 20



AUGUST 6

Assignment 2 - Video or Annotated Podcast

- In Assignment 1, you used the documentary *Welcome to India*, one course reading, and one recent news article to develop a topic, case study, and proposed strategy for addressing an issue in the city where you currently reside.
- In Assignment 2, you will return to that work and deepen it. You will add:

One new peer-reviewed academic journal article

One government, institutional, community, or organizational response connected to your issue

- Your goal is not simply to repeat your original argument from Assignment 1. Instead, you will critically examine how your thinking has developed, what your new research reveals, and what kind of response is needed to address the issue more effectively.
- Your podcast or video should evaluate the relationship between academic theory, media representation, lived/local realities, and actual policy or organizational responses.



```
mirror_mod = modifier_ob.  
set mirror object to mirror  
mirror_mod.mirror_object =  
operation == "MIRROR_X":  
mirror_mod.use_x = True  
mirror_mod.use_y = False  
mirror_mod.use_z = False  
operation == "MIRROR_Y":  
mirror_mod.use_x = False  
mirror_mod.use_y = True  
mirror_mod.use_z = False  
operation == "MIRROR_Z":  
mirror_mod.use_x = False  
mirror_mod.use_y = False  
mirror_mod.use_z = True  
  
selection at the end -add  
ob.select= 1  
mirror_ob.select=1  
context.scene.objects.active  
("Selected" + str(modifier  
mirror_ob.select = 0  
bpy.context.selected_obj  
data.objects[one.name].select  
print("please select exactly  
OPERATOR CLASSES -----  
  
types.Operator):  
X mirror to the selected  
object.mirror_mirror_x"  
mirror X"  
  
context):  
context.active_object is not
```

Assignment 2

- Due July 27th
- Worth 20%

Assignment 2 - Video or Annotated Podcast

Length:

- Podcast: 8–10 minutes
- Video: 7–9 minutes

Assignment 2 - Video or Annotated Podcast

- **Section 1: Introduction**

Introduce topic, city, case study

- State your original focus from Assignment 1
- Your original solution or plan of action
- How your thinking has shifted or deepened

- **Section 2: Academic and News Engagement**

Ask yourself, what does the course article help me understand, and how does the new journal article add to, support and complicate my understanding.

- **Section 3: Case study and Current Context**

In this section, return to your case study and explain how the issue appears in a current, local, or specific context. Why does the case study matter, and why is it relevant to your city?

Assignment 2 - Video or Annotated Podcast

- **Section 4: Governmental or Organizational Response**

In this section, examine one government, institutional, community, or organizational response to the issue in your case study.

- **Section 5: Revisiting the Plan of Action**

In Assignment 1, you proposed a strategy or plan of action. In this section, you must return to that proposal and critically evaluate it in light of your new research.

- **Section 6: Reflection and Conclusion**

Assignment 2 - Video or Annotated Podcast

Include six annotations:

- One key course concept
- One connection to the course article
- One connection to the new peer-reviewed academic article
- One timestamped documentary reference
- One annotation identifying the government or organizational response
- One annotation showing a connection, tension, or contradiction across at least two sources

Please include these in the form of an accompanying PowerPoint to the video or a narrated podcast. Tutorial 4 will assist with formatting.

Questions
related to the
Assignment?



What characterized the industrial city
and what developmental era are we
currently in?

```
..._mod.mirror_object =  
operation == "MIRROR_X":  
    mirror_mod.use_x = True  
    mirror_mod.use_y = False  
    mirror_mod.use_z = False  
operation == "MIRROR_Y":  
    mirror_mod.use_x = False  
    mirror_mod.use_y = True  
    mirror_mod.use_z = False  
operation == "MIRROR_Z":  
    mirror_mod.use_x = False  
    mirror_mod.use_y = False  
    mirror_mod.use_z = True
```

```
selection at the end  
mirror_ob.select= 1  
mirror_ob.select=1  
context.scene.objects.active  
= mirror_ob  
print("Selected" + str(modifier.name))  
mirror_ob.select = 0  
= bpy.context.selected_object  
data.objects[one.name].select  
= 1  
print("please select exactly  
one mirror")
```

--- OPERATOR CLASSES ---

```
bpy.types.Operator):  
    X mirror to the selected  
    object.mirror_mirror_x"  
    name = "Mirror X"
```


Post Industrial Cities and Neoliberalism

What is a Post-Industrial City?

- A shift from cities that had an economy based in manufacturing and industrial production, to one based on more on service industries, information and research.
- This is important for thinking about the characterization of cities, and economic growth.
- Post industrial and Neoliberalism - what is the relationship here?

Neoliberalism

- The principal mechanisms for achieving this transformation centered on tax cuts and deficit spending, deregulation and privatization. Starting from the late 1970s onward.
- Individualism and Meritocracy
- The influence of the free market and private interests
- Privatization, incorporating the contracting out of selected local government services
- Less government intervention in the economy

Neoliberalism

- ❑ The aim here was restructuring urban areas economically, socially, spatially and ideologically around a new consensus of free-market individualism and rejection of the social democratic consensus of the welfare state

Pacione, 2006

- ❑ **Should cities engage in marketing campaigns and strategies to boost economic development and attract investment? Why or why not?**

THE CREATIVE CLASS



RICHARD FLORIDA

- “International bestselling author, professor and urbanist”
- Director of Cities the Martin Prosperity Institute at the Rotman School of Management
- Research professor at New York University
- Identified by MIT as one of the world’s most influential thinkers;

The background of the slide is an aerial photograph of a city skyline, featuring numerous skyscrapers and buildings. A semi-transparent red rectangular overlay covers the majority of the image, creating a monochromatic effect. The title 'THE CREATIVE CLASS' is centered within this red area in a white, bold, serif font. Below the title, a thin white horizontal line separates it from a list of four bullet points. The bullet points are also in white serif font and are preceded by small green circular markers. The overall design is clean and professional, with a focus on urban development and the creative economy.

THE CREATIVE CLASS

- An 'emerging class' whose members are engaged in creative work
- Movement towards a post-industrial knowledge-based society.
- Cities brand themselves through initiatives that cater to the creative class.
- Cities seek to provide an urban environment that offers technology, talent, and tolerance

Who Belongs To The Creative Class?

1. SUPER-CREATIVE CORE

Responsible for the creation and introduction of ideas into the mainstream, e.g. scientists, engineers, researchers, analysts, non-fiction writers, artists etc.

- coming up with a theorem or strategy that can be applied in many cases; or composing music that can be performed again and again

1. CREATIVE PROFESSIONALS

Individuals whose work requires them to add “creative value” to their work by having to think for themselves .

- people engage in creative problem solving, drawing on complex bodies of knowledge to solve specific problems. Highly educated

- “creative professionals” – those who “work in a wide range of knowledge-intensive industries such as high-tech sectors, financial services, the legal and health care professions, and business management” e.g. doctors, legal professionals.

The Creative Class

Members of the Creative Class do not own and control any significant property in the physical sense

Their property – which stems from their creative capacity – is intangible because it is literally in their heads.

Values of the Creative Class

- **Individuality:** Members of the Creative Class endeavor to create individualistic identities that reflect their creativity - self-expression, eccentricity, quirkiness;
- **Meritocracy:** The Creative Class favours hard work, challenge and stimulation. Creative Class people are ambitious and want to move up based on their abilities and effort
- **Diversity and Openness:** Talented people defy classification based on race, ethnicity, gender, sexual preference or appearance.

Creative Class and Economic Growth

- The main point I want to make here is that the basis of the Creative Class is economic
- I define it as an economic class and argue that its economic function both underpins and informs its members' social, cultural and lifestyle choices.
- The Creative Class consists of people who add economic value through their creativity. It thus includes a great many knowledge workers, symbolic analysts and professional and technical workers.

Richard Florida

Creative Class and Economic Growth

- The creative class has an association with the information and knowledge industries
- Acts as a driver for tourism - creativity and culture can be used to market a place to outsiders;
- Promoting growth by transforming older, neglected neighbourhoods into desirable places to live, work and play.

Creative Class and City Regional Economies



MARKETS FOR CREATIVITY,
E.G. TOURISM;



CREATIVE SECTORS, E.G. FILM
AND TELEVISION INDUSTRIES,
TECHNOLOGY RESEARCH;



INNOVATION (IDEAS AS
CAPITAL), E.G. STEM
RESEARCH.

THE CREATIVITY INDEX

- ❑ **High-Tech:** economic presence of the high-tech sector;
- ❑ **Innovation:** investment in research and innovation;
- ❑ **Talent:** human capital and size of the creative class.
- ❑ **Composite Diversity:** different manifestations of diversity:
 - Melting Pot Index: ethnic and racial diversity; multicultural presence
 - Bohemian Index: artists, musicians, writers and performers
 - Gay Index: size of the gay and lesbian population;

Creative Class, Innovation and Economic Growth

“The weight of this evidence thus supports the central contention that the city and the region lie at the very centre of the processes of innovation and entrepreneurship and form the basic spatial platform for these processes.

It is the city itself that brings together the firms, individuals, talent, and other institutions and services that drive these critical processes.

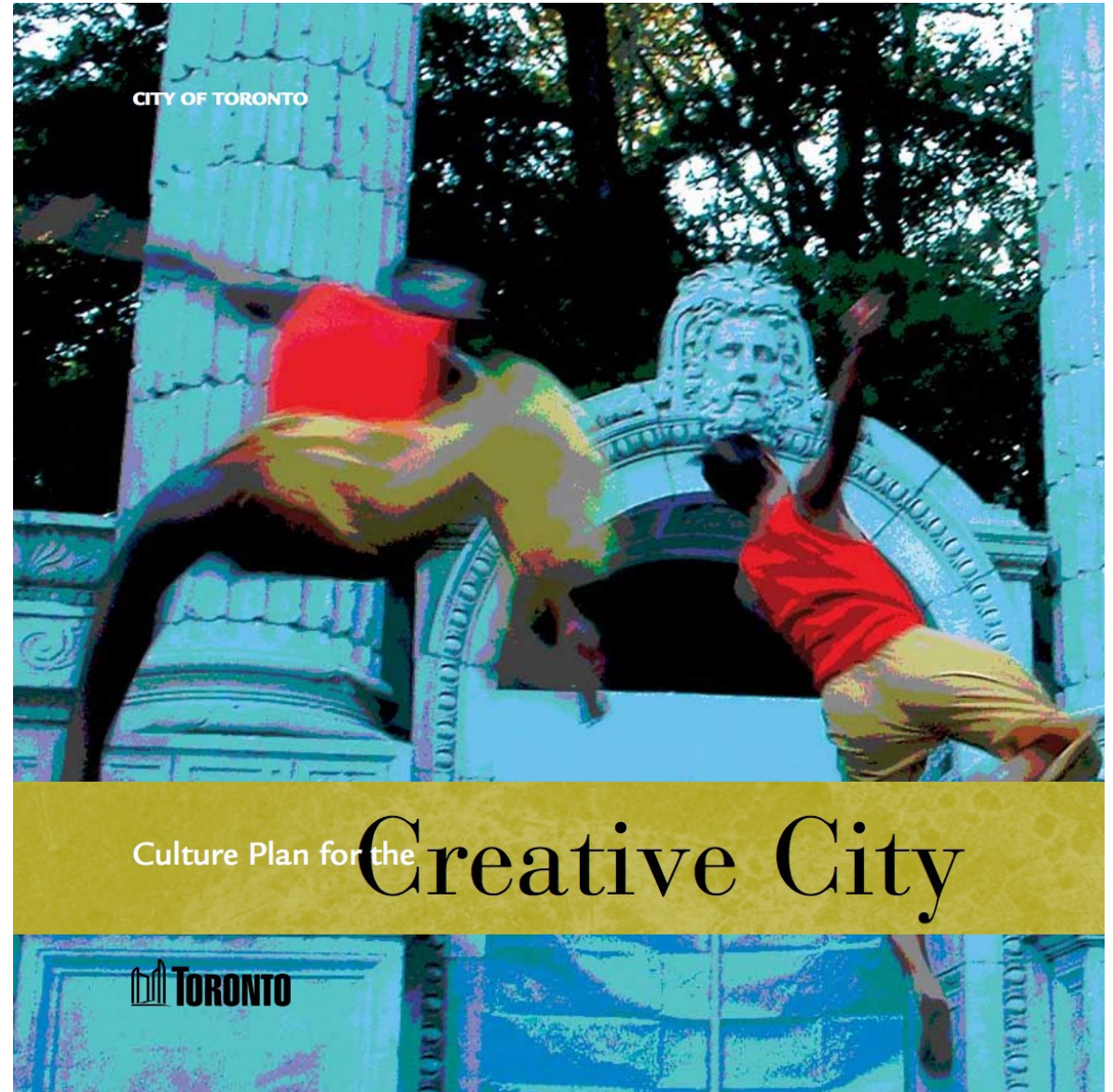
Essentially, innovation and entrepreneurship are more quintessentially urban or regional processes than firm- or individual-level ones.”

R. Florida

Creativity and Culture In Toronto's Official Plan

City of Toronto Culture Plan
(2003)

“Each dollar invested (directly and indirectly) in cultural activities by the City generates 3.2 dollars in economic activity. So, Toronto's additional investment of \$25 million in its cultural sector will generate \$80 million in new economic activity each year.”



Creativity and Culture In Toronto's Official Plan

The City's *Culture Plan* will position Toronto as a "Creative City", a leading international culture capital. The Official Plan policies support these efforts.

Cultural Industries – Cultural industries have their origin in individual creativity, skill and talent and have a potential for wealth and job creation through the generation and advancement of intellectual property, including: design, broadcasting, film video and photography, music and the visual and performing arts, publishing, software, computer games and electronic publishing.

3.5.2 CREATING A CULTURAL CAPITAL

A great city offers and promotes a vibrant cultural life. It recognizes the contribution the arts make to the quality of life of its residents. For Toronto to become one of the great cities of the 21st century, we will need to nurture leading-edge imagination and build on the strength of our rich diversity of cultural expression. A flourishing cultural life is a magnet attracting new residents to the City and convincing existing residents to stay.

Arts and cultural activities, including expressions of popular culture, crafts and multiculturalism associated with everyday activities, enrich the day-to-day quality of life of Toronto's residents and workers and play an important role in the look and feel of the City, our collective identity and the image we project beyond Toronto's borders. Our cultural industries are also an important sector of our local economy. Strategic municipal support for our cultural capital will contribute to a healthy City economy, promote cultural tourism and help us to be competitive in attracting and keeping businesses, particularly in the relatively mobile knowledge-based industries.

There is a critical role for the City to play in keeping existing and creating new performance venues, studios, rehearsal and administrative spaces, galleries and museums. We can also continue

Creativity and Culture In Toronto's Official Plan

to welcome film production and location filming throughout Toronto. Community arts endeavours in the hundreds of libraries and community, cultural and recreation centres should also be supported in order to provide opportunities for people of all ages and cultural backgrounds to experience arts and cultural activities and explore their creativity. Some of our surplus municipal properties could be dedicated to arts and cultural centres while we encourage other levels of government to do likewise.



Policies



1. A full range of arts and cultural activities, from community-based endeavours to nationally prominent institutions, will be promoted and supported in Toronto to express the cultural diversity of our communities.
2. The arts and cultural community will have access to City owned facilities and properties, including surplus properties, for non-profit community arts performance venues, arts education and training programs, studio, rehearsal, storage and administrative space.
3. The inclusion of new, not-for-profit arts and cultural facilities in development will be promoted through development incentives and public initiatives.
4. The arts and cultural community will be encouraged to participate in local design and beautification efforts.
5. Concentrations of cultural activities will be promoted to create arts districts and corridors that can collectively draw visitors and revitalize communities.



Heather Mclean - Cracks in the Creative City

- Argues that cities with global city aspirations try to boost their economy and attract cultural tourists by using urban regeneration strategies.
- These creative city strategies are also used to attract investors.

“The staging of blockbuster festivals also signals the neoliberalization of cultural policies. In the Canadian context, this means that since the mid-1990s a key public arts funding strategy has been to invest in mega-events that promise economic development, especially through increased tourism” (p.2158).

- One example used here is arts festivals, but what are some others that you think Toronto use for this purpose? Do these festivals make you feel more socially included in the city?

Cracks in the Creative City

Let us tease out a few of the examples/points provided by McLean.

- “Creative city events often privilege performances of diversity that appeal to the tastes of middle-class professionals and align with planning efforts to securitize neighbourhoods” – fetishizing ethnoracialized communities
- “Urban artistic interventions work to hide racialized exclusions and hierarchies inscribed in urban space”
- “Additionally, artists engaging in social practice interventions within creative city initiatives can naturalize racialized inequalities (Kwon, 2004). For example, artists risk reproducing colonial discovery narratives when they invite festivalgoers to ‘discover’ and interact with low-income communities”.

McLean, 2014



Break - 5 Minutes

Are Creative Cities Deepening Inequality?

- <https://www.npr.org/2017/04/10/523237746/author-richard-florida-on-the-new-urban-crisis>.



NEWSLETTERS SIGN IN NPR SHOP

DONATE

NEWS CULTURE MUSIC PODCASTS & SHOWS SEARCH

AUTHOR INTERVIEWS

Author Richard Florida On 'The New Urban Crisis'

APRIL 10, 2017 · 5:07 AM ET
HEARD ON MORNING EDITION



7-Minute Listen

+ PLAYLIST

TRANSCRIPT



Steve Inskeep talks to author Richard Florida — who has made a career studying cities, both culturally and economically. Florida's new book is called *The New Urban Crisis*.

Transcript

STEVE INSKEEP, HOST:

One of the most influential thinkers about cities is rethinking.

RACHEL MARTIN, HOST:

Richard Florida promotes what he calls the creative class. He has said for years that cities prosper when they attract upscale innovators and entrepreneurs. Make your city a place where the creative class wants to live,

GENTRIFICATION & DISPLACEMENT

```
mirror object to mirror  
mirror_mod.mirror_object
```

```
operation == "MIRROR_X":  
    mirror_mod.use_x = True  
    mirror_mod.use_y = False  
    mirror_mod.use_z = False  
operation == "MIRROR_Y":  
    mirror_mod.use_x = False  
    mirror_mod.use_y = True  
    mirror_mod.use_z = False  
operation == "MIRROR_Z":  
    mirror_mod.use_x = False  
    mirror_mod.use_y = False  
    mirror_mod.use_z = True
```

```
selection at the end -add  
mirror_ob.select= 1  
mirror_ob.select=1  
context.scene.objects.active  
("Selected" + str(modifier_name))  
mirror_ob.select = 0  
= bpy.context.selected_objects  
data.objects[one.name].select  
print("please select exactly 1")
```

```
-- OPERATOR CLASSES -----
```

```
bpy.types.Operator):  
    X mirror to the selected  
    object.mirror_mirror_x"  
    mirror X"
```


Gentrification Recap

- The process of change in an area resulting from an influx of wealthier people into less prosperous neighbourhoods;
- Artists and students often function as “pioneers” of gentrification;
- Rising housing prices lead to informal economic eviction of original residents;
- Changes in the dominant symbolic coding of the area lead to cultural displacement;
- Changes in dominant land-use.

Revitalization or Displacement - Regent Parkers Reflect on The Effects of Revitalization

Deborah is a Cooperative student at FOCUS MEDIA ARTS CENTRE

Since 1949, Canada's first historical public housing project in Regent Park has grown and has become the largest within the city. The plan was to support lower-income communities while they tried to improve their circumstances.

Since 2005, Regent Park's revitalization plans were to transform aging infrastructure into an improved community that provided housing to mixed-income individuals and their families. The housing mix included new rental buildings, townhouses, commercial spaces, community centres, parks and other new residential buildings.

To attract new homeowners, recent plans for adding bike lanes, wider roads and improvements to public transit are in the process of being made and are meant to help connect Regent Park to the rest of the modernized City of Toronto.

With these drastic changes to the Regent Park community, some local residents strongly oppose the revitalization saying that it increases displacement and many are concerned about how new homeowners will interact with longtime residents.

To gauge residents' thoughts on the matter and to assess the extent to which Regent Park community members feel that the changes in the neighbourhood are good or bad, two RPTV reporters, Kedar Ahmed and Fabio Rivera, went out to the streets around Regent Park to capture people's thoughts.

While on balance, quite a few people were highly positive about the revitalization, there were detractors too. For example, two local workers at Regent Park, Krysta and Dan, shared their thoughts on the matter. "You force the people that live here out, 'cause they can't afford to live here anymore or you've torn down the building they used to live in and that just to me feels like gentrification."

Another individual said, "Definitely the rents going up, (that is)... a huge part (of gentrification), lack of (affordable) housing, building condos and dispensaries, there's not really much resources for a lot of people."

Website: <http://www.focusmediarts.ca>

Ontario - Regent Park (TO)
Recent Media

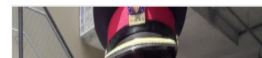


City's New Protest Bylaw Draws Concern
Anti-Black Racism Committee Meeting

Advisory members and residents question
exclusion zones and call for equity in civic
decision-making.

ON - Regent Park (TO)

24



Toronto's Regent Park

- Regent Park was developed in the late 1940s and early 1950s, housing approximately 7500 low-income residents in 2005.
- The redevelopment began in 2006 and will replace 1800 non-market units while adding 5400 market units and 200 affordable housing units.
- The project is a response to declining government funding for social housing and increasing real estate values in downtown Toronto.
- Residents expressed frustration over the perceived neglect of their input in decision-making processes, leading to feelings of disempowerment.

Brail and Kumar (2006)

Is Gentrification inevitable?

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=H_4j74b4SWE - New Regent Park study shows lessons learned with redevelopment
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yj1H8Sdc8Sw> – Gentrification is not inevitable: Care and Resistance

Revitalization without Gentrification

- Revitalization should include socially mixed housing - refers to housing that includes a range of tenure types and/or income levels
 - Intentional efforts to foster interaction
- Social mix is assumed to result in improved socio-economic outcomes for low-income residents through sharing of information and resources between people of different socio-economic status
- Revitalization should prioritise community consultation, engagement and interaction.

Brail and Kumar (2006)

Discussion

- Please check the tab under the materials for this week on the modules page.
- Upload by the end of class - 1pm.
- Please respond in 150 – 250 words.
- ❖ How does the creative class theory fit into conversations of gentrification in Toronto? Is there an ethical way of gentrifying a neighbourhood?

Next Steps

Reflections on Urban Planning

- Hall, Peter. 2015 [2001]. “The City of Theory.” Pp. 431-444 in *The City Reader*
- Nejad, S., Walker, R., & Newhouse, D. (2020). Indigenous placemaking and the built environment: toward transformative urban design. *Journal of Urban Design*, 25(4), 433–442.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/13574809.2019.1641072>

